

MAURYAN, BUDDHIST, JAIN AND ROCK-CUT HERITAGE

Continuous at-a-glance master roll: origin > typology > sites > traps > 2020 answer route
Core-first visual for Topic 02 only / built from the repaired learning session and workbook

THESIS -> monuments preserve patronage + ritual use + inscription + long reuse
READ THEM AS SOURCE CLUSTERS, NOT SITE LISTS
BEST EXAM MOVE -> named site + what it proves + one explicit limitation

01 | TWO TIMELINES

- Ancient development from Mauryan to Ellora
- Separate modern survey / UNESCO chronology
- Use chronology only to prevent anachronism
- Anchor dates: 3rd c. BCE, early 5th c. CE, 6th-12th c. CE

03 | BARABAR-NAGARJUNI

- Amaravati, Bharhut / 3rd c. BCE
- Ashoka + Dasharatha -> Ajanta dedications
- Polished granite monoliths and ascetic form facade
- Oldest Indian rock-cut architecture

05 | SANCHI

- Mauryan core -> Shunga enlargement -> Satavahana toranas -> Gupta alterations
- Best example of acroton in stone
- Pillar carries Schism Edict
- UNESCO 1989 is modern status, not ancient date

07 | CHAITYA / VIHARA

- Chaitya = apsidal worship hall with stupa focus
- Vihara = monastic residence with cells
- Sites: Karle / Nasik / Bhamburda / Kumbhari / Pithavara
- Never overlaps the two terms

09 | UDAYAGIRI + ELEPHANTA

- Udayagiri (Vidisha) = Chandragupta II + Varaha + Gupta inscriptions
- Elephanta = Bharatpur island + Sadashiva / Trimurti
- Brahmanical cave turn is major phase
- Elephanta's main patronage remains debated

11 | JAIN SPINE

- Udayagiri-Khandagiri + Mathigumpha
- Temple / colossal / Nishidha expansion
- Dharsana, Ranigumpha, Shriyambhadracharya, Shriyambhadracharya
- Dedicatory programmes, often shared regional style

02 | MAURYAN FRAME

- Court art vs non-courtly is useful but porous
- Pillars = monolithic shaft + capital + abacus + inscription
- Bharhut / Amaravati / Sanchi show site variation
- Mauryan polish is evidence, not a total explanation

04 | STUPA LOGIC

- Pre-Buddhist memorial background
- Andia / vedika / pradakshina / hankika / chattr / torana
- Poles = milestones + Kumbha
- Parts matter only when linked to function

06 | BHARHUT + AMARAVATI

- Bharhut = aniconic, narrative, Shunga comparator
- Amaravati = lower Krishna Mahabharata + Ajanta pillars
- Limestone relief work and long excavation history
- Do not state Amaravati size without caution

08 | AJANTA

- Wahgura gurgel, Sahyadri hills, Maharashtra
- Two major phases: early + Vakatake-era later phase
- Chaityagumpha + vihara, unroofed caves show technique
- Painting caution: tempera / fresco secco is safer

10 | ELLORA

- 34 caves + 12 Buddhist + 17 Brahmanical + 3 Jain
- Sequence with overlap across 6th-12th centuries
- Cave 10 (Vishvakarma) / Cave 16 (Kalyani)
- Bharhut gate combines Bhayana / Kalyani forms

12 | 2020 GS-1 ROUTE

- Define rock-cut as historical source
- Use Bharhut + chaitya/vihara + Ajanta/Ellora + inscription
- State durable patronage limitation explicitly
- Avoid cave tour writing and false precision

HERITAGE TRAPS -> do not reverse chaitya / vihara / do not conflate Ellora / do not treat Mathigumpha as realistic / do not use UNESCO dates as ancient chronology
BEST CLOSE -> stone preserves architecture, image and inscription together, but it over-represents durable patronage rather than the beliefs of early Indian society